

M06 DAX & REPORTING PRACTICE GUIDE

Use with RetailPulse workbook + your own PBIX

Teacher demo -> guided build -> changed context -> independent validation -> evidence.

PBD1 - Measures first: the calculation layer

1. Open exactly

C1_M06_POWERBI_DAX_REPORTING_PRACTICE_DATA_RC1.xlsx, your current M06 PBIX, and the matching learner-book lesson. Keep protected review closed.

2. Follow with me

Create explicit measures: Line Count, Order Count, Customer Count, Total Quantity, Gross Sales, Net Sales, Total Cost, Profit, Margin %, Average Order Value. Save a card/table page and explain SUM vs SUMX and DIVIDE.

3. Expected / validate

Base measures reconcile to protected practice anchors; implicit raw-column aggregation is not used as the final KPI logic.

4. Changed independent try

On a fresh scenario, rebuild the base measure set with different column names and prove one measure using an independent manual/filtered check.

5. Evidence before review

Save PBIX/version name, relevant measure list/DAX, report/QA screenshots, validation evidence, one failure/recovery note, confidence 1-5 and a short own-words explanation.

PBD2 - Evaluation context: why the same measure changes

1. Open exactly

C1_M06_POWERBI_DAX_REPORTING_PRACTICE_DATA_RC1.xlsx, your current M06 PBIX, and the matching learner-book lesson. Keep protected review closed.

2. Follow with me

Create Category x Region matrix with Net Sales and Profit plus Region/Category slicers. Predict three selections before clicking, test them, and write the observed contexts.

3. Expected / validate

Matrix/slicer results match predictions or corrections; learner can name the active filters that explain each change.

4. Changed independent try

Given a changed matrix/slicer design, predict five context outcomes before interaction and explain any wrong prediction after testing.

5. Evidence before review

Save PBIX/version name, relevant measure list/DAX, report/QA screenshots, validation evidence, one failure/recovery note, confidence 1-5 and a short own-words explanation.

PBD3 - CALCULATE: deliberately changing context

1. Open exactly

C1_M06_POWERBI_DAX_REPORTING_PRACTICE_DATA_RC1.xlsx, your current M06 PBIX, and the matching learner-book lesson. Keep protected review closed.

2. Follow with me

Create East Sales, Electronics Sales, All Category Sales and Category Share %. Validate category shares under a Region slicer and explain the denominator context.

3. Expected / validate

Share denominator behavior is correct; shares reconcile sensibly and do not all show 100%.

4. Changed independent try

Build a share-of-total measure for a different dimension and prove the denominator ignores only the intended breakdown filter while respecting another slicer.

5. Evidence before review

Save PBIX/version name, relevant measure list/DAX, report/QA screenshots, validation evidence, one failure/recovery note, confidence 1-5 and a short own-words explanation.

PBD4 - KPI measures and targets

1. Open exactly

C1_M06_POWERBI_DAX_REPORTING_PRACTICE_DATA_RC1.xlsx, your current M06 PBIX, and the matching learner-book lesson. Keep protected review closed.

2. Follow with me

Relate Regions and Date to Monthly_Targets; create Sales Target, Variance to Target and Target Attainment %. Compare by Region + Month and explain why daily target is unsupported.

3. Expected / validate

Target totals are evaluated at Region + Month grain; actual/target/variance/attainment reconcile to the target table and no unsupported daily target is presented.

4. Changed independent try

Use a different target table at Branch + Month grain. Build actual/target/variance/attainment and reject one intentionally wrong daily visualization.

5. Evidence before review

Save PBIX/version name, relevant measure list/DAX, report/QA screenshots, validation evidence, one failure/recovery note, confidence 1-5 and a short own-words explanation.

PBD5 - Time intelligence that you can defend

1. Open exactly

C1_M06_POWERBI_DAX_REPORTING_PRACTICE_DATA_RC1.xlsx, your current M06 PBIX, and the matching learner-book lesson. Keep protected review closed.

2. Follow with me

Create Sales YTD, Sales PY, YoY %, Previous Month Sales and MoM %. Build a monthly 2025-2026 line chart and test January 2026 against December 2025 plus one prior-year period.

3. Expected / validate

January 2026 previous month equals December 2025; prior-year measure uses the same comparable period; YTD increases logically across months.

4. Changed independent try

Use a different two-year dataset to build YTD/PY/YoY/previous-month/MoM and prove a year-boundary month plus one missing-prior-period blank is legitimate.

5. Evidence before review

Save PBIX/version name, relevant measure list/DAX, report/QA screenshots, validation evidence, one failure/recovery note, confidence 1-5 and a short own-words explanation.

PBD6 - Visual selection and page hierarchy

1. Open exactly

C1_M06_POWERBI_DAX_REPORTING_PRACTICE_DATA_RC1.xlsx, your current M06 PBIX, and the matching learner-book lesson. Keep protected review closed.

2. Follow with me

Build a 16:9 Executive Summary: 4-5 KPI cards, monthly trend, Category bar, Region bar and one supporting matrix/table. Save a three-sentence design rationale.

3. Expected / validate

Each visual answers a named question, formats are consistent, reading order is obvious and the page does not rely on color alone.

4. Changed independent try

Redesign a cluttered executive page for a different stakeholder: keep only the questions that support one decision and defend every visual kept/removed.

5. Evidence before review

Save PBIX/version name, relevant measure list/DAX, report/QA screenshots, validation evidence, one failure/recovery note, confidence 1-5 and a short own-words explanation.

PBD7 - Interactivity without confusion

1. Open exactly

C1_M06_POWERBI_DAX_REPORTING_PRACTICE_DATA_RC1.xlsx, your current M06 PBIX, and the matching learner-book lesson. Keep protected review closed.

2. Follow with me

Add only useful Date/Region/Category slicers, inspect Edit interactions, create one drillthrough page and one report-page tooltip, then save one verified interaction state.

3. Expected / validate

Filter/highlight/none behavior matches intent; drillthrough receives the selected context; tooltip values do not contradict the source visual.

4. Changed independent try

Configure a changed report where one slicer should not affect one diagnostic visual; prove Edit interactions, drillthrough context and tooltip values are correct.

5. Evidence before review

Save PBIX/version name, relevant measure list/DAX, report/QA screenshots, validation evidence, one failure/recovery note, confidence 1-5 and a short own-words explanation.

PBD8 - Report validation: prove the story is true

1. Open exactly

C1_M06_POWERBI_DAX_REPORTING_PRACTICE_DATA_RC1.xlsx, your current M06 PBIX, and the matching learner-book lesson. Keep protected review closed.

2. Follow with me

Create a QA page/log and reconcile line count, order count, customer count, Net Sales and Profit. Add one target check, one time-intelligence check and one slicer-interaction check.

3. Expected / validate

At least seven validation checks have Expected/Actual/Status and include base, breakdown, target, time and interaction evidence.

4. Changed independent try

Receive a report with one planted wrong KPI/context behavior. Use the validation ladder to identify the failing layer and document Expected -> Actual -> Cause -> Fix.

5. Evidence before review

Save PBIX/version name, relevant measure list/DAX, report/QA screenshots, validation evidence, one failure/recovery note, confidence 1-5 and a short own-words explanation.

PBD9 - Publish, workspaces, refresh and sharing basics

1. Open exactly

C1_M06_POWERBI_DAX_REPORTING_PRACTICE_DATA_RC1.xlsx, your current M06 PBIX, and the matching learner-book lesson. Keep protected review closed.

2. Follow with me

If allowed, publish to My workspace and inspect report/semantic model; otherwise demonstrate Desktop Refresh and write the publish/refresh workflow accurately.

3. Expected / validate

Workflow distinguishes publishing from data refresh and states account/tenant limitations accurately; no fabricated service evidence.

4. Changed independent try

Write a deployment/refresh handoff for a new source location, explicitly separating Desktop refresh, semantic-model refresh, credentials, gateway and sharing permissions.

5. Evidence before review

Save PBIX/version name, relevant measure list/DAX, report/QA screenshots, validation evidence, one failure/recovery note, confidence 1-5 and a short own-words explanation.

PBD10 - RLS basics, handoff and defense

1. Open exactly

C1_M06_POWERBI_DAX_REPORTING_PRACTICE_DATA_RC1.xlsx, your current M06 PBIX, and the matching learner-book lesson. Keep protected review closed.

2. Follow with me

Create static East Only role, use View as roles, prove other regions disappear, then write the final handoff checklist and a 90-second project defense.

3. Expected / validate

RLS role visibly restricts rows under View as roles; handoff includes KPI definitions, refresh/source notes, validation and security assumptions.

4. Changed independent try

Create a different static RLS role (for example one Club/Zone/Clinic), validate it with View as roles, and explain why the role is security while a slicer is not.

5. Evidence before review

Save PBIX/version name, relevant measure list/DAX, report/QA screenshots, validation evidence, one failure/recovery note, confidence 1-5 and a short own-words explanation.